ENG-0008 Incident Postmortem: INC-110

Impact

The incident involving the auth-api system, identified as INC-110, resulted in a Sev1 severity level disruption. The auth-api, a medium-criticality system utilizing Python/Django/MySQL, experienced an outage that affected core authentication services. The disruption lasted for approximately 1.5 hours, during which users were unable to access authentication functionalities. Cristian Santos, Head of Engineering, reported the incident, which temporarily impacted Project Titan's operational capacity. The swift resolution minimized overall business impact, but highlighted vulnerabilities in change management procedures.

Timeline

- **2025-02-06**: The incident was reported by Cristian Santos, Head of Engineering, indicating a critical failure in the auth-api system.
- **Immediate Response**: Cameron Parker, on-call engineer and Financial Analyst, was alerted and initiated incident response procedures.
- **Resolution**: The root cause was identified as a configuration change applied to auth-api. The change was reverted, restoring system functionality.
- **Resolution Time**: The incident was resolved within 1.5 hours from initial report.

Root Cause

The root cause of INC-110 was classified as a configuration change. An unauthorized or improperly documented change was implemented to auth-api, which led to the system's failure. This change was not adequately tested or reviewed prior to deployment, resulting in the outage. The incident underscores the importance of strict change management protocols, especially for systems critical to Project Titan.

Action Items

Item	Description	Responsible Party	Due Date	Status
1	Review and reinforce change management procedures for auth-api and similar systems.	Project Lead, E-097	2025-02-13	Pending
2	Conduct a root cause analysis of the configuration change process to identify gaps.	Engineering Team Lead	2025-02-10	Pending
3	Implement additional safeguards, such as change approval workflows and testing protocols, for future configuration changes.	DevOps Team	2025-02-20	Pending
4			2025-02-18	Pending

Item	Description	Responsible Party	Due Date	Status
	Provide refresher training on change management policies to all relevant personnel, including Cameron Parker and others involved in system updates.	HR & Training Department		
5	Schedule a post-incident review meeting with all stakeholders, including Cristian Santos and Cameron Parker, to discuss lessons learned and preventive measures.	Project Manager	2025-02-12	Pending

This incident highlights the necessity of rigorous change control processes to prevent recurrence of similar outages. Continuous improvement in operational procedures will be prioritized to safeguard the integrity and availability of auth-api and other critical systems within Project Titan.